

CULTURETECHLENS

Culture, Clearly Seen.

BLACK CULTURAL INTELLIGENCE

THE CULTURETECHLENS INDEX · EDITION 2026-10

The CTL 10: Artifacts

Ten everyday objects ranked by their combined presence in public attention and CultureTechLens's documented research record.

The Afro pick holds the deepest CTL evidence in the set - and the lowest public attention.

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Methodology: CTL-IDX-001 v1.1

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The ranking reveals two kinds of cultural presence

Cadillac leads the composite Index at **78.8**, powered by the edition's highest public-attention signal. The Afro pick ranks ninth overall but reaches **100.0 in evidence depth**, revealing a subject the archive knows deeply even when the public is not looking it up.

33,922

Cadillac pageviews in the published 30-day window - highest in the set.

100.0

Afro pick evidence-depth score - strongest CTL documentation.

62.1

Yearbook momentum score - highest positive movement.

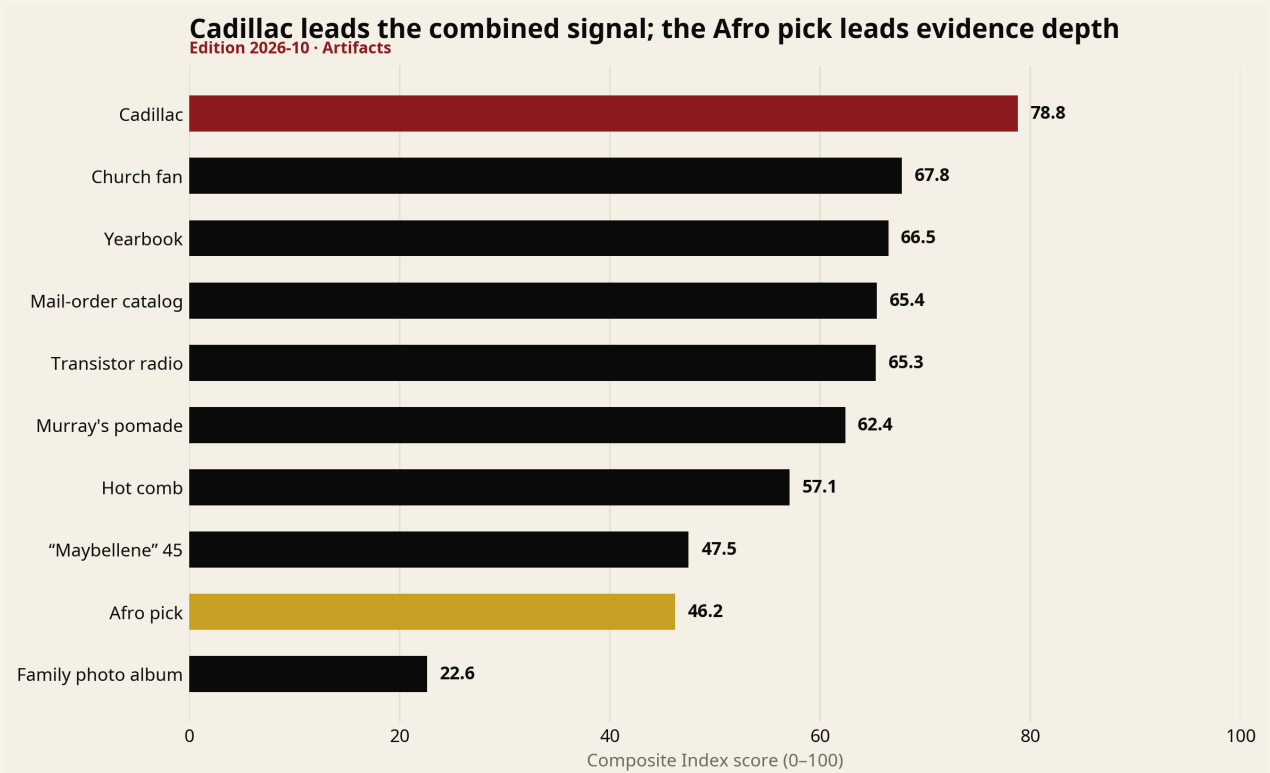


Figure 1. Composite score by rank. Red identifies the overall leader; gold identifies the edition's signature attention-evidence gap.

Interpretation, not coronation. The Index measures resonance in two records: what people are seeking and what CultureTechLens has documented. Rank is a description of those signals, not a judgment of cultural worth.

Source: CultureTechLens Index scored table, Edition 2026-10. Signal weights: attention 40%, evidence depth 40%, momentum 20%.

Every rank is open to inspection

The composite score is built from three normalized signals. The pageview count is the published raw attention measure; the three signal columns show the normalized values used in the calculation.

Rank	Artifact	Score	Attention 40%	Evidence 40%	Momentum 20%	Pageviews
1	Cadillac as cultural object	78.8	100.0	75.0	44.0	33,922
2	Funeral-home advertising church fan	67.8	70.4	79.5	39.2	6,156
3	Yearbook 1955 Allen University "Yellow Jacket"	66.5	51.0	84.1	62.1	2,015
4	Mail-order catalog Sears / Montgomery Ward	65.4	55.8	77.3	60.9	2,655
5	Transistor radio Regency TR-1	65.3	65.4	70.5	54.9	4,624
6	Murray's Superior Hair Dressing Pomade tin	62.4	65.4	65.9	49.6	4,611
7	Hot comb / pressing comb	57.1	38.1	84.1	41.3	958
8	45-rpm single Chess 1604, "Maybellene"	47.5	57.5	36.4	49.9	2,928
9	Afro pick fist-handle hair pick	46.2	0.0	100.0	30.9	106
10	The Black family photograph album	22.6	32.1	0.0	48.6	680

Why Cadillac leads

Its attention score reaches the top of the normalized set, while its evidence depth remains substantial. That combination outweighs modestly negative momentum.

Why the album matters

The photograph album's low evidence score identifies a gap in the current CTL corpus, not a lack of cultural importance. It is an invitation to document more.

Values reproduced from *index-scores.csv*. Scores are rounded to one decimal. "Pageviews" is the published recent-window total used to derive the attention signal.

The archive can be deep where attention is thin

The edition's most useful result is not a rank. It is the distance between two measures of presence.

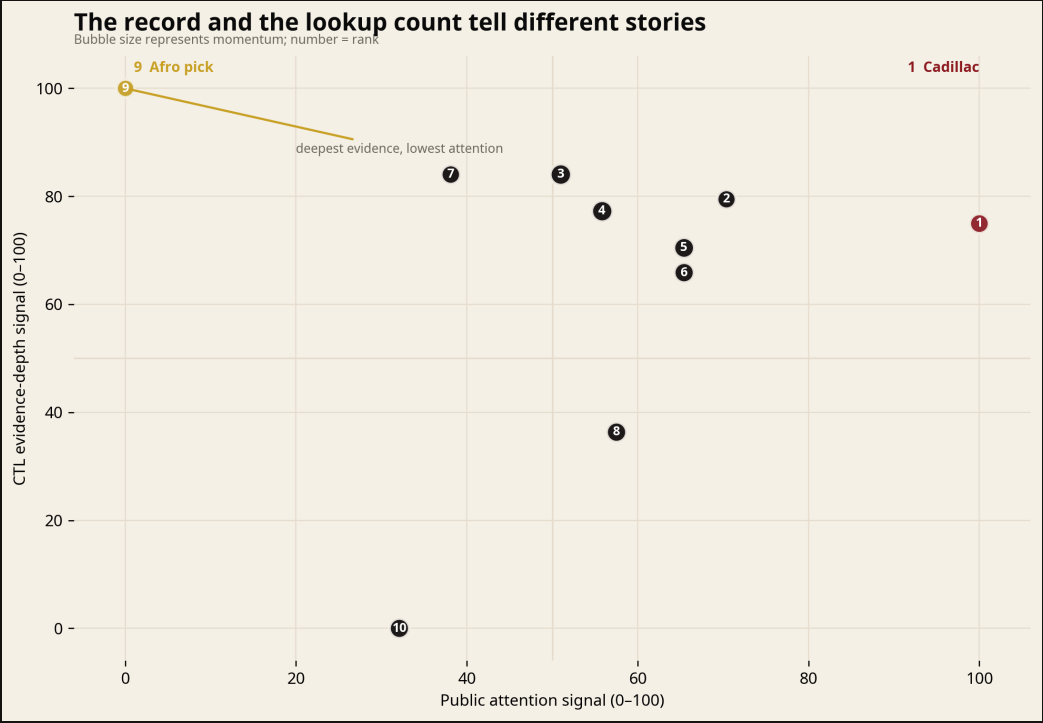


Figure 2. Attention versus evidence depth. Numbered circles correspond to rank; circle size represents momentum.

Afro pick: evidence-rich, attention-poor.
Six verified claims, four provisional claims, four relationships, and a full Object Biography produce the set's highest evidence score. The public-attention total is 106 pageviews.

Cadillac: attention-rich, evidence-strong.
The set's largest public-attention total, 33,922 pageviews, combines with a 75.0 evidence score to produce the leading composite.

● overall leader ● signature gap ● other ranked artifacts

“What can an ordinary object remember that the history books forgot?”

The guiding question comes from CTL-DR-LIFE-001, *How We Lived: An Encyclopedia of Black Everyday Life*.

The method makes the ranking reproducible

The Index measures cultural resonance: how present a subject is in current public attention and in the documented CTL research record. It does not measure greatness, worth, or community sentiment.

40%

Public attention

English Wikipedia pageviews for each subject's closest article, published as a recent-window total and log-normalized across the ten candidates.

40%

Evidence depth

Verified and provisional claim counts, relationship counts, and a full Object Biography bonus from source package CTL-DR-LIFE-001, normalized across the set.

20%

Momentum

The pageview trend for the recent window versus the prior window. A normalized value of 50 represents flat attention.

0

Editorial overrides

The composite is computed by *ctl-index.py*. Scores are not hand-tuned. Ties resolve by evidence depth, then alphabetically.

What the published method cannot claim

- Wikipedia attention favors subjects with English-language articles and internet-era visibility.
- Evidence depth reflects what CultureTechLens has researched so far; under-documented subjects score lower by construction.
- The Index describes resonance in records, not sentiment on the ground.
- Ranks can move with recomputation; movement is a signal, not a verdict.

SOURCE PACKAGE

CTL-DR-LIFE-001

How We Lived: An Encyclopedia of Black Everyday Life

CORRECTIONS STATUS

None as of publication

Updates are recorded in the public edition file.

Audit path

The public repository contains the methodology, candidate set, evidence table, scoring script, ranked output, and scored CSV:

<https://github.com/culturetechlens/culturetechlens-index.git>

This edition is ready to cite

Use the citation below in reporting, research, exhibitions, teaching materials, and community documentation. Preserve the document identifier so future corrections and editions remain distinguishable.

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Source record

1. CultureTechLens. *CultureTechLens Index, Edition 2026-10: Artifacts*. CTL-IDX-003, 2026.
2. CultureTechLens. *The CultureTechLens Index: Methodology*. CTL-IDX-001, version 1.1, 2026.
3. CultureTechLens. *Edition 2026-10 scored table*. index-scores.csv, 2026.
4. Public project repository: <https://github.com/culturetechlens/culturetechlens-index.git>

Corrections and publisher

Corrections are dated in the public edition record; cite the revision date when applicable. CultureTechLens is Chicago's Black cultural intelligence platform, curating history, athletics, music, and technology through cultural preservation and analysis.